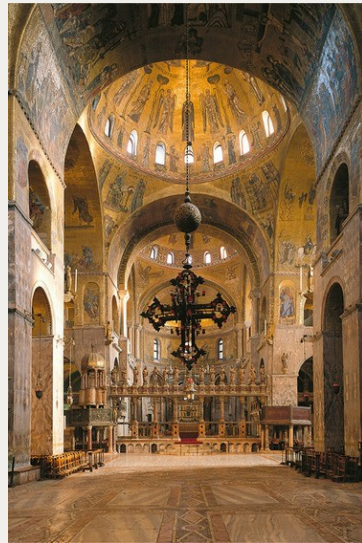


IN CONTEXT

St. Mark's, Venice

Vivaldi's first known appearance as a musician came at the age of 18, when he performed alongside his father as a violinist in St. Mark's, Venice's most important church. It was built mainly in the late 11th century and has a long tradition in music. The eminent composers associated with it include Giovanni Gabrieli, who was principal organist in 1585–1612, and Claudio Monteverdi, who was music director in 1613–1643. Music featured not only inside the church but also in religious processions in St. Mark's Square.



THE NAVE OF ST.
MARK'S CHURCH,
VENICE, ITALY

Vivaldi's name is inseparable from his most famous work, *The Four Seasons*, one of the most frequently performed and recorded